Little Lion in the Big Halfmoon

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/73781526.

Rating:
General Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

Category:
Gen

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Adora & Catra (She-Ra), Catra & Catra's Mother (She-Ra), Catra & Catra's Father (She-Ra), Adora & Catra's Father (She-Ra), Adora & Catra's Mother (She-Ra), Cyrus/Lyra (Defiance), Adora (She-Ra) & Cyrus (Defiance), Adora (She-Ra) & Lyra (Defiance), Adora (She-Ra) & Kesi (Defiance), Catra (She-Ra) & Cyrus (Defiance), Catra (She-Ra) & Lyra (Defiance), Catra (She-Ra) & Kesi (Defiance)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Catra's Mother (She-Ra), Catra's Father (She-Ra), Original Female Character(s), Original Male Character(s), Original Trans Character(s), Cyrus (Defiance), Lyra (Defiance), Kelara (Defiance), Kesi (Defiance)

Additional Tags:
Fluff, Humor, Raised in Halfmoon AU, Adorable Adora (She-Ra), Adorable Catra (She-Ra), they're both still five in this one, Halfmoon (She-Ra), Magicat Catra (She-Ra), Magicats (She-Ra), POV Adora (She-Ra), fic of a fic, Ficception, Recursive Fanfiction, Kesi Cult, Kesi is the Besti

Language:
English

Series:
Part 3 of Defiance - Raised in Halfmoon AU

Stats:
Published: 2025-11-06 Words: 2,236 Chapters: 1/1

Little Lion in the Big Halfmoon

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/73781526.

Rating:
General Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

Category:
Gen

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationships:
Adora & Catra (She-Ra), Catra & Catra's Mother (She-Ra), Catra & Catra's Father (She-Ra), Adora & Catra's Father (She-Ra), Adora & Catra's Mother (She-Ra), Cyrus/Lyra (Defiance), Adora (She-Ra) & Cyrus (Defiance), Adora (She-Ra) & Lyra (Defiance), Adora (She-Ra) & Kesi (Defiance), Catra (She-Ra) & Cyrus (Defiance), Catra (She-Ra) & Lyra (Defiance), Catra (She-Ra) & Kesi (Defiance)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Catra's Mother (She-Ra), Catra's Father (She-Ra), Original Female Character(s), Original Male Character(s), Original Trans Character(s), Cyrus (Defiance), Lyra (Defiance), Kelara (Defiance), Kesi (Defiance)

Additional Tags:
Fluff, Humor, Raised in Halfmoon AU, Adorable Adora (She-Ra), Adorable Catra (She-Ra), they're both still five in this one, Halfmoon (She-Ra), Magicat Catra (She-Ra), Magicats (She-Ra), POV Adora (She-Ra), fic of a fic, Ficception, Recursive Fanfiction, Kesi Cult, Kesi is the Besti

Language:

English

Series:
Part 3 of Defiance - Raised in Halfmoon AU

Stats:
Published: 2025-11-06 Words: 2,236 Chapters: 1/1

Little Lion in the Big Halfmoon

by tp9829, Zelenal

Summary

Adora is given the grand tour of her new home and meets someone special.

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

- Inspired by Defiance by TheNotebookWizard

The Crescent Market

Halfmoon

Subtheria

Ten Days After the Coup Attempt

Adora looked around in awe at the Crescent Market. She had spent her entire life that she could remember in the Horde main compound so seeing the world zoom by her during their escape had been amazing enough but this was something else. She had never seen so many people—Magicats—before in her whole life! What's more, in the Horde, everyone of the same race usually looked similar enough but the Magicats of Halfmoon had *so* much more variety! There were some that were thin and some that were varying levels of fat (Adora's never seen a fat person before!). Then there were all of the various fur colors and stripe patterns and hair (Mane?) styles and eye colors (They didn't have any white in their eyes!).

And then there were the clothes! Adora could see a couple people here and there who *seemed* to be wearing a uniform but nearly everyone *didn't.* Instead, they were all kinds of different clothes in so many different colors that Adora didn't even always have words for! Some of them were even barely wearing any clothes at all! What's more, a lot of them were wearing other things! They had things on their tails or attached to their ears and a few had things attached to their eyebrows and belly buttons!

"And this, Little Lion, is the Crescent Market; the heart of Halfmoon," King Tiger, who was currently carrying Adora, said as he gestured to the area around them with his free hand. They, Catra, and Queen Lyra (who was carrying Catra) were currently showing Adora around Halfmoon. (Adora has tried to insist that she could walk on her own but King Tiger had said that it was

really easy to get lost in Halfmoon and he didn't want her to get lost so Adora had relented.) "You can buy all kinds of things here!"

"Buy?" Adora asked with a tilt of her head as she looked at King Tiger again.

King Tiger hummed in thought for a moment before saying, "It's kinda like requisitioning—you know what that is, right?" When Adora nodded, he continued. "It's like that but you're usually getting it from the person who made it and you have to trade for it. You almost always trade using something called 'money.'"

Adora nodded seriously at King Tiger's explanation which, for some reason, made him smile. "And how do you get money?"

King Tiger laughed. "You don't have to worry your brave little head about that, Little Lion."

"We'll make sure you're taken care of," Queen Lyra added with a nod.

"Yeah!" Catra said. "Mama and Dadda take real good care of me so they'll take real good care of you, too!"

King Tiger and Queen Lyra shared a look before King Tiger said, "So, Little Lion, what do you want to check out first?"

Things had been *crazy* for Adora ever since she arrived in Halfmoon a week ago. She had spent almost that entire time in the infirmary which had bothered her a lot but she had managed to make it through alright thanks to King Tiger, Catra, and Dr. Lenio (who was *really* nice, unlike the doctors in the Horde). She had gotten to eat what King Tiger had called "real food" for the first time and it tasted better than Adora ever could have imagined; it made the grey ration bars seem worse than the brown kind in comparison!

King Tiger had laughed at the look of wide-eyed wonder on Adora's face before she dug into her food like a starving wolf

(Starving lion?) only to then eat just as much as she did. Catra had also eaten a lot but not as much as Adora and King Tiger while Queen Lyra had eaten what she called a "normal amount." (Adora had asked why she wasn't eating what she could when she could since she might not get the chance to later. This had made everyone sad for some reason until King Tiger distracted everyone with a joke.) They then ate like that *again* later that day and ate all kinds of food three times a day since then!

Adora had then asked if this was just the way Princess people ate but was told that everyone eats well three times a day if they want to and that there were these things called "snacks" that people sometimes ate between meals. That then led to Adora being introduced to snacks and she was immediately in love.

The more Adora learned about Halfmoon, the more it seemed like the Horde had been wrong about literally everything. Even *magic* wasn't scary as Dr. Lenio used it to help make her feel better while Queen Lyra had shown off her own magic by making pretty things out of pure fire!

When Dr. Lenio finally said that Adora and Catra were free to go after staying in the infirmary for four days (King Tiger had to stay for longer since he was hurt a lot more), Adora had been shown around Halmoon Palace. She had met all kinds of people like Percival (who was Queen Lyra's "Seneschal"—whatever that was) and Cloudfoot (who was Percival's husband and then Adora had to ask what a husband was which Cloudfoot was more than happy to explain; he had been happy to answer *all* of Adora's questions!). Not all of them were as nice as those two but none of them had been mean.

Adora had then spent the next couple days playing with Catra whenever Cloudfoot wasn't teaching her all kinds of things (Catra found the lessons to be boring but Adora thought that they were exciting! She at least got Catra to actually pay attention to them, much to Cloudfoot's delight) or they weren't being shown around the palace by either Cloudfoot, Percival, or Queen Lyra.

Once King Tiger had *finally* been allowed to leave the infirmary, he had suggested that all of them go out together to show Adora around Halfmoon and now here they are: eating cinnamon rolls from Tathlan's Bakery.

Leaving the Horde with Tiger and Catra was the best decision that Adora's ever made in her life!

The High Temple

Halfmoon

Subtheria

Ten Days After the Coup Attempt

"Here we are! The High Temple!" King Tiger said with another sweeping gesture as he led the way to a large building that seemed to be built into those stone thingies that hang down from the ceiling and come up from the ground in caves. It was a very pretty building but Adora didn't know what it was for.

"What do you do here?" she asked. She was currently walking hand-in-hand with Catra in between King Tiger and Queen Lyra.

"The High Temple serves many purposes," Queen Lyra began, "but it's where people who believe in the Celestial Promise come to pray, among other things."

"What's the Celestial Promise?"

Queen Lyra smiled at Adora. "You'll be meeting someone who can tell you all about it soon."

By the time Queen Lyra finished speaking, they had entered the doors of the building and were quickly greeted by an old-looking (not as old as Dr. Lenio but close) Magicat and another one who looked to be only a bit older than Adora (she was *really* pretty).

"You're Magesties! Welcome!" the old-looking Magicat greeted them. "And I see that you've brought Her Highness and the Etherian girl that King Cyrus rescued." When she looked at Adora, her eyes widened slightly before darting to Queen Lyra who slightly shook her head.

"Please, Kelara. When it's just us, you can call me 'Cyrus,'" King Tiger said with a wave. "Anyway, we're showing Adora here," he placed a hand on Adora's head, "around and thought to pay you a visit."

"Very well then, Cyrus. And I'm glad; religion is an important part of Halfmoon, after all. Ah, but please excuse me. This is my great-granddaughter, Kesi. Kesi, these are Their Majesties Queen Lyra and King Cyrus Dr'iluth as well as Her Highness, Princess C'yara Dr'iluth."

"I-It's an honor to meet you," Kesi said stiffly as she bent her knees while moving one foot behind the other and spreading her hands out a little. Adora had *no idea* what that was but she seemed super nervous so Adora decided to do something about that.

Adora let go of Catra's hand to stand in front of Kesi. "It's nice to meet you, Kesi! I'm Adora!" Adora then tried to do what Kesi had done only to lose her balance and topple forward. The only thing that stopped her from faceplanting was the pair of soft arms that suddenly surrounded her.

"Whoa! Careful, Adora!" Kesi said with a slight laugh as she helped her to stand back up. It wasn't what Adora had intended but she seemed less nervous now so she'd take it. Adora's mind was distracted by something else at that moment, however.

"You're fur is *really* soft. And pretty. You're pretty! Thank you for catching me!" Adora said with a big smile.

Kesi seemed to shrink in on herself a little as her ears tilted back, her tail lashed, and a low rumbling sound came from her

chest. “Th-thank you. And you’re welcome!”

Now Adora was distracted by something completely different. “What’s that sound that you’re making? I heard King Tiger make it when he was rescuing me and Catra.”

Adora frowned as the sound stopped even as Kesi looked confused. “King Tiger? Catra?”

“That’s called ‘purring,’ ‘Dora!” Catra said as she walked up to them.

“Why do you purr?” Adora asked Catra.

“Lots of reasons! Usually when we’re really happy!”

“Can *I* purr?”

“I… don’t *think* so?” Catra said as she looked at Kesi.

Kesi smiled and shook her head. “No, you can’t. Only Magicats and certain animals can purr.”

“Awww…” Adora pouted. “I bet you that I *can* purr!”

Catra giggled. “You can try, ‘Dora, but I don’t think you’re gonna do it.”

“Oh yeah? Watch me!” Catra and Kesi watched on with amused interest as Adora tried her level best to purr. She started off with a humming sound and steadily pitched it lower and lower. Their eyes then started to widen and their ears perked up as the humming went lower still and shifted into a vague rumbling. Finally, after maybe a solid minute or two of concentrated effort, Adora was almost purring and had the smuggest grin on her face.

“What,” was all Kesi could say as she listened to this impossibility. Catra wasn’t even managing *that* much. This seemed to have caught the attention of the adults (who had walked away

at some point) as they all turned to look at Adora with similar expressions of shock.

"Adora? Is that *you* making that noise?" King Tiger asked as the adults came back over.

Adora stopped her purring and smiled up at him. "Yep! That was me! Kesi said that I couldn't purr but I *totally* can!"

"I— But— You— How—" Queen Lyra repeatedly tried to start before evidently *giving up.*

A moment passed in silence and then another before Kelara cleared her throat. "Well. That it is certainly something that you can do. Moving on, don't Your Majesties have something to say?"

"Right!" King Tiger said as he shook himself. He stepped closer to Adora before kneeling down to be closer to eye level with her. "Little Lion, we've been talking and you're going to be living with Kelara and the other clergy in the Temple."

Both Catra and Adora looked distressed by this news as Catra ran over to Adora and clung to her. "I thought that 'Dora was gonna be living with us!"

"Yeah!" Adora said as she clung on to Catra. "I've been living with you guys the past couple days so why do I gotta leave?"

King Tiger made a face like he had just eaten a brown ration bar and looked up at Queen Lyra. "Honey?"

Queen Lyra huffed and rolled her eyes before smiling softly at Adora and Catra. "I know, sweaties, but that was because Cyrus was still recovering. Now that he's back on his feet, the two of us have a *lot* that we need to do and C'yara needs to learn how to be a princess. But don't worry, you two will see each other plenty."

"You promise?" Adora asked as she wiped away the tears that had been threatening to form in her eyes.

"I promise," Queen Lyra said softly.

"You'll be taken good care of here and Kesi comes by often so you'll be able to play with her, too, if she doesn't mind," Kelara reassured.

"I don't! I'd *love* to play with you, Adora!" Kesi said brightly.

Adora perked up a little at this and sniffed before wiping her eyes one last time and letting go of Catra. "Okay. Okay! This'll be fun!"

"You better take good care of her! I'll be *real mad* if you don't!" Catra threatened as she let go of Adora.

Kelara chuckled slightly at this. "Of course. Your wish is my command, You Highness," she said with a bow, bringing both fists up over her heart.

Adora's mouth dropped open in shock as she rounded on Kesi. "Why did you do that weird bendy thing instead of that? I could have *totally* done that!"

Everyone laughed.

End Notes

Fun Fact: Adora being able to psuedo-purr is, in fact, canon to *Defiance*. TheNotebookWizard revealed this little tidbit over on the Discord server. If you want to find it, search the questions-and-answers channel for "humming" and you'll find it pretty much immediately.

So, a couple things happened in this fic that Adora completely missed due to, ya know, being five years old. For starters, showing her around Halfmoon the way they did served multiple purposes. Aside from the obvious, it also did the following: bolstered the morale of the civilians by showing that the royal family remains strong despite everything, acted as a power move against the traitors by showing them that they ultimately failed, and to let the people of Halfmoon know that Adora was under the protection of the royal family.

When Cyrus and Lyra shared a look, it was due to their plan to have Adora be raised as a ward of the Temple and the clergy within. When Lyra and Kelara shared a look, it was because Kelara had sensed the absurd amount of celestial magic in Adora and was looking for direction. Lyra shaking her head told her to not talk about it in front of Adora since Lyra (and Lenio) had also sensed it. This is, in fact, one of the reasons why they brought Adora to Kelara; she's the best one suited to teach Adora how to control her magic. That's what the adults were talking about while the kids did their thing.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!